Care Quality Commission

Citygate, Gallowgate, Newcastle upon Tyne NE1 4PA · www.cqc.org.uk · 03000 616161

Maple Court Care Home — Inspection report (DRAFT, for factual accuracy check)

Inspection dates: 11–12 February 2025 · Report published: [DRAFT — not yet published] · Type: Responsive / focused inspection

Key question	Rating (proposed)
Overall	Inadequate
Safe	Inadequate
Effective	Requires improvement
Caring	Good
Responsive	Requires improvement
Well-led	Inadequate

Summary of findings

We carried out this responsive inspection because of concerns about the management of medicines following a safeguarding referral. We found that the service was not always safe and that governance arrangements were not effective. Medicines were not managed safely across the service and there was no medicines audit in place. The service was staffed by agency nurses with no permanent nursing presence on the affected unit. The registered manager was not aware of the incident until the inspection. The provider failed to notify CQC of the incident.

Is the service safe? — Inadequate

People were not protected from the risk associated with the unsafe management of medicines. A resident prescribed an anticoagulant did not receive prescribed doses on two consecutive days. The omission was not identified by staff or by the provider's audit arrangements, and the resident was later admitted to hospital. Competency assessments for staff administering medicines were not consistently in place.

Is the service well-led? — Inadequate

Governance systems did not identify or address the risks relating to medicines. Audit arrangements were not effective. Leadership oversight of the affected unit was insufficient during a period of reliance on agency staffing.

This is a draft report provided to the registered provider for the purpose of checking factual accuracy before publication. The provider has 10 working days to submit factual accuracy comments.